

Gender Selection in Digital Forms (and stored in databases)

Objectives:

- Introduce students to gender options in a database
- Consider how to store gender in a database
- Consider how to ask a user for their gender in a digital form

More than Other – selecting a gender to be stored:

Step 1) Pick one (or more) of these articles to read. The articles discuss how technologists ask for and store gender selection options and consider how those options are stored in a database:

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2022/08/22/1057853/software-coding-more-gender-options/>

<https://civic.mit.edu/index.html%3Fp=1165.html>

<https://williamsinstitute.law.ucla.edu/publications/data-collection-sogi/>

Step 2) Reflect on the following questions and write-down your answers:

- A. Share your thoughts on gender selection options in digital forms and databases. Should the options include more than just male and female? Why or why not?
- B. Have you heard about genders beyond male and female prior to reading this article – such as non-binary, etc.?
- C. As you begin your database design studies, do you think it is necessary to aim for inclusive design, why or why not?
- D. Who benefits from inclusive design? Is anybody harmed by including more gender options beyond male and female?

Step 3) Submit your written answers as described by your instructor.